

Shafiee-Jood, Majid (ms2dm)

From: Berger, Amelie Cecile (acb4rk)
Sent: Friday, May 9, 2025 1:47 PM
To: Shafiee-Jood, Majid (ms2dm)
Cc: Mcglathery, Karen J (kjm4k)
Subject: Climate Collaborative LOI feedback

Dear Majid and team,

Thank you for submitting a Letter of Intent to our Climate Collaborative program. The review committee has met to discuss the LOIs and we are sharing below their detailed feedback on the strengths and weaknesses of your LOI.

We want to let you know that there may be changes in the Climate Collaborative program, due to recent developments last week in the federal funding landscape and its implications for the University. We are likely adjusting the timeline for full proposals to a date sometime after August 15th. We are moving forward with the program, but may need to make some adjustments to the number and scale of projects we are able to support. We will be in touch within the next month with more specifics on our path forward.

Please don't hesitate to reach out if you have any questions about the feedback or would like to talk further.

Feedback on the LOI:

Overall, the reviewers found your LOI to be very strong and the proposed project highly promising. Your focus on septic system resilience addresses an important and timely challenge, and is closely aligned with the program's goals around climate adaptation and resilience. Reviewers appreciated the well-articulated problem and solution framing, the clarity of your research questions, and the thoughtful integration of methods—including sensing, modeling, decision-support, and policy/finance.

The existing partnerships and prior work leveraged were seen as significant strengths. The interdisciplinary team was well-justified and well-matched to the project's goals, and the collaboration with the University of Maryland was viewed as a strategic addition that broadens the project's reach. The budget was also seen as thoughtfully constructed, with a clear emphasis on community ownership.

We recognize that the LOI is a short description of the project and doesn't contain all the details that would be in the full proposal. Areas to focus on that would strengthen the submission suggested by the reviewers include:

- Clarify the novelty and distinctive contributions of the work
- Further articulate the broader applicability and potential national relevance of the project outcomes
- Provide more details about your community partners and the specific engagement activities planned
- Discuss potential pathways for follow-on funding and long-term institutional support

We're excited to see how the full proposal develops and look forward to your submission.

Regards,
Amelie and Karen, on behalf of the review team

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